

LASD Matters, Issue 1: Transparency, Bonds, and Taxes

Hello! I'm Vladimir Ivanovic, a former Los Altos School District (LASD) Board member. I resigned in March 2026 because I could not support the Board's decision to move 650 Bullis Charter School (BCS) students to a new campus to be built just for them on land that LASD acquired in 2019. I think it's the wrong decision for a multiple reasons that I'll go over in another issue of "LASD Matters".

For now, I want to highlight what I believe is the Board's deliberate lack of transparency about what a recent bond measure was for, and the why that's important.

In November 2024 LASD voters passed Measure EE, a \$350M bond measure to upgrade LASD facilities. Strange as it may seem, the measure's legally required ballot summary didn't mention that 40% of the bond proceeds were to be used to give BCS the newest and best campus in all of LASD. This opacity was not accidental because being upfront about how 40% of Measure EE was not going to benefit LASD schools would have sunk the bond measure. As it turns out, the measure barely passed with just a 1.2% margin, leaving LASD taxpayers on the hook to pay back an estimated \$730M over the next 30 years that won't do what they expected.

There are at least two important and serious consequences that have barely been discussed in public. One is that Measure EE will increase property taxes by ~\$600 to ~\$1200 or more per year until Measure EE is paid off – in 30 years. (The actual annual increase is \$30 per \$100,000 of assessed value. For a home assessed at \$2M, that \$600/year; for a \$4M home, that \$1200/year.) The upsetting part is that only a portion of this new property tax will benefit LASD schools.

Another consequence, not discussed at all, is the difficulty LASD will face to pass two or more additional bond measures, bond measures that must be passed to complete the Facilities Master Plan. People, in general, don't like to be hoodwinked twice, so it's doubtful that these new bond measures will pass. Additionally, the pass rate of bond measures in LASD has been dropping for years, and that will also make passing two more bond measures hard. The most likely outcome, once again, is that LASD will not have enough money to upgrade its existing facilities nor replace portables with permanent buildings, leaving BCS with LASD's only modern campus. I don't think this is an outcome that voters expected or wanted.

Visit <https://github.com/vgivanovic/vgivanovic.github.io/wiki> to find references, documentation, and PDF versions of LASD Matters issues.